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Introduction

This guide explores how selected Artificial Intelligence (AI) tools can support learners with neurodevelopmental disorders, with a focus on the study of Modern Languages. As digital technologies become increasingly integrated into education, AI offers new opportunities to reduce barriers to learning, promote independence, and provide personalised support tailored to individual needs. For students with conditions such as dyslexia, autism spectrum disorder (ASD), attention deficit hyperactivity disorder (ADHD), and other neurodevelopmental differences, AI tools can help make language learning more accessible and engaging.

Modern Language assessments often require students to demonstrate a broad range of skills, including reading, writing, listening, speaking, grammar, vocabulary acquisition, and cultural understanding. These tasks can present additional challenges for neurodivergent learners, particularly where difficulties with processing, organisation, memory, concentration, or communication are involved. AI technologies can provide practical assistance by offering real-time feedback, personalised learning pathways, speech-to-text and text-to-speech capabilities, translation support, vocabulary reinforcement, and study organisation tools.

The intended audience for this guide is undergraduate students of Cardiff University, with a focus on those studying Modern Languages. This guide covers a wide range of functionality provided by selected AI tools, how to use them, and how they can help Modern Languages students with task preparation. This guide is a baseline for how AI tools can be used, and in no way covers every single use of every single tool covered, just ways in which we have identified could help students. This guide provides a baseline overview of how AI tools may be used to support neurodivergent students. It does not seek to cover every possible application of the tools included but rather highlights selected uses that were identified as potentially beneficial across different aspects of the student experience. The development of the guide was further informed by feedback from volunteer students within the Modern Languages (MLANG) community, whose reflections and lived experiences helped refine its content, relevance, and accessibility.

AI tools should be viewed as supplementary support mechanisms rather than replacements for existing reasonable adjustments, specialist support services, or inclusive teaching practices. The effectiveness of any tool will vary according to individual needs, preferences, and contexts, and students should be encouraged to identify the approaches that best support their learning.

Why these disorders?

What is neurodiversity

Neurodiversity is the concept of that there is natural variation in the ways that the human brain works, signifying that there is no one “correct” way to think, learn, or process information.

“Neurodiversity is the concept that there is natural variation in how people’s brains work, with no single “correct” way, and that a wide range of perceptions and responses to the world should be accepted and encouraged” – (Child Mind Institute, 2026).

What disorders are we covering, and why?

Dyslexia

Evidence

Dyslexia effects reading accuracy, spelling, phonological processing and vocabulary. These difficulties can impact reading comprehension, grammar, and written language production in Modern Languages. (University of Strathclyde, n.d.)

Rationale for inclusion

Modern Language relies heavily on reading, writing, spelling, and pronunciation. AI tools that can perform text-to-speech, speech recognition, and grammar support that can provide huge benefits for those who struggle.

Possible link to assessments/ tasks

- Writing exams
- Reading exams
- Vocabulary
- Pronunciation activities

Dyspraxia

Evidence

Dyspraxia can affect motor coordination, planning and organisation, handwriting speed and notetaking. People with dyspraxia may also struggle with planning (e.g. creating a plan for tasks and projects). (Dyspraxia Foundation (2012)

Rationale for inclusion

Written tasks and language learning activities often require extensive notetaking and written production, AI based speech-to-text may reduce these barriers. AI tools can also be used to effectively plan tasks and create timelines.

Possible link to assessment/tasks

- Notetaking
- Written Tasks
- Project Planning

Attention Deficit Hyperactivity Disorder (ADHD)

Evidence

ADHD can affect concentration, working memory, time management and task completion. Learners may struggle to remember vocabulary, organise revision, or sustain attention span during lengthy lessons and tasks. (Royal Borough of Windsor and Maidenhead, n.d.)

Rationale for inclusion

Modern Languages tasks require sustained focus and structured responses. AI tools can support planning, revision planning, resource organisation, and personalised learning.

Possible links to assessments/ tasks

- Writing task
- Listening tasks
- Revision and coursework management

Autism (autism spectrum disorder)

Evidence

Autistic learners may experience challenges with social communication, interpreting figurative language, or understanding contextual clues. Language learning often involves cultural interpretation and communication skills. (Reachout ASC (n.d.)).

Rationale for inclusion

Modern Languages requires both linguistic and social communication competencies. AI tools can provide structured explanations, conversational practise and personalised learning environments.

Possible links to assessments/ tasks

- Speaking assessments
- Cultural interpretation tasks
- Group tasks

Processing disorders

Evidence

Processing disorders can affect auditory, visual, and speed of processing. This means that tasks such as reading, listening, following instructions, vocabulary retention, and language comprehension may be challenging, particularly in the study of Modern Languages. (National Center for Learning Disabilities (n.d.))

Rationale for inclusion

Modern Language Learning requires learners to quickly process spoken language and written information, remember new vocabulary, and interpret meaning from context. AI tools that provide text-to-speech, content summarisation, and personalised pacing can help reduce barriers for learners with processing difficulties

Possible link to assessments/ tasks

- Writing exams
- Reading exams
- Vocabulary
- Multi step instructions
- Note taking

Why is a recourse like this relevant to Cardiff University, and education as a whole?

Inclusive education and recognition of learners at Cardiff University with neurodevelopmental disorders is very important. Neurodivergence is real and impacts people in all different areas of life. Cardiff University has 7% (1,980) of students that have disclosed that they are neurodivergent as of the 25/26 academic year, along with 7.8% (40) of MLANG students that have also disclosed the fact they are neurodivergent.

With this number of students that have disclosed that they are neurodivergent, it is still very common for people to get to the point of being in the first year of their university course, unaware that they are neurodivergent, and therefore do not get the support they need. Promoting this topic is important, as it will allow for people to get support they did not know they needed, helping further contribute to equality in education.

Statistics from higher education state that neurodiversity is increasingly important in the sector, with recent statistics showing that 22% of UK students have a neurodivergent diagnosis, with up to 28% identifying as neurodivergent in some way. This contributes to an overrepresentation of neurodivergence among students compared to the general population, of which only 15-20% are believed to be neurodivergent (Eves, 2026). This highlights the growing importance of neurodiversity in higher education and reinforces the need for targeted strategies and resources that enable neurodivergent students to thrive academically

Why these tools?

We conducted a comprehensive review of a wide range of tools to identify those most suitable for neurodivergent students at Cardiff University. The evaluation began with an initial shortlist of 11 tools, which were assessed against a set of rigorous criteria to determine their suitability and effectiveness. The criteria used in the evaluation are outlined below:

Evaluation criteria and rating of selected AI tools

What we are evaluating these tools for:

Criterion	Definition	Indicators	Rating (1-5)
Accessibility	The extent to which this tool is accessible for the targeted students with neurodevelopmental disorders	Text-to-speech, clear language, keyboard accessibility, simple interface, adjustable text size, captions.	1 = Poor 5 = Outstanding
Personalisation	The features provided which allow the users to change the app, to promote a more user specific experience	Tailored explanations, adjustable difficulty, personalised feedback, response customisation.	1 = Poor 5 = Outstanding
Cognitive load and management	The extent that the tool can help reduce unnecessary mental effort	Step-by-step guidance, concise responses, chunking of information, minimal distractions.	1 = Poor 5 = Outstanding
Pedagogical Usefulness	How well the AI tool supports meaningful learning and problem solving.	Accurate explanations, scaffolding, constructive feedback, encourages critical thinking.	1 = Poor 5 = Outstanding

The criteria for scoring:

Score	Meaning
1	Does not meet the criteria, not fit or purpose
2	Meets the criteria to a limited extent, improvements would be needed
3	Meets the criteria moderately, basic use possible
4	Meets the criteria, intended use very possible
5	Meets the criteria fully, intended use is excellently provided.

First, we started creating a series of relevant categories, aligned to features in an app that would be useful to our target audience. We then created a criterion for scoring across characteristics of every category we have defined.

Below are the scoring criteria:

Accessibility:

Indicator	What to look for	Rating 0 – 5
Clear and readable interface	Clean layout, readable fonts, minimal clutter	
Accessible communication	Uses plain language and can simplify explanations	
Multiple ways to interact	Supports text, voice, images, or other input/output methods	
Computability with accessibility features	Works with screen readers, keyboard navigation, text-to-speech, etc.	
Sensory accessibility	Avoids overwhelming visuals or unnecessary distractions	
Total		Points average

Personalisation:

Indicator	What to look for	Points 0 – 5
Adaptive explanations	can simplify, expand, or rephrase content	
Adjustable response style	User can request different formats, lengths, or levels of detail	
Personalised feedback	Feedback reflects the learner's responses rather than generic advice	
Supports individual learning pace	Learners can revisit, repeat, or build on previous explanations	
Flexibility	Can generate examples, quizzes, summaries, or alternative explanations	
Total		Points average

Cognitive load management

Indicator	What to look for	Points 0 – 5
Chunking information	Breaks information into manageable sections	
Step by step guidance	Explains tasks sequentially	
Concise explanations	Avoids unnecessary complexity or information overload	
Organisation	Uses headings, bullet points, summaries, or logical structure	
Attention support	Keeps responses focused and avoids irrelevant information	
Total		Points

Pedagogical usefulness

Indicator	What to look for	Points 0 – 5
Concept explanation	Explains reasoning rather than only giving answers	
Constructive feedback	Identifies mistakes and explains how to improve	
Encourages critical thinking	Prompts learners to think rather than simply copy	
Supports independent learning	Helps learners solve problems themselves	
Learning reinforcement	Provides examples, practice questions, summaries, or revision support	
Total		Points

From this point, we made note of an average score from a section, and add it to every other average score to get a total score for the app. From this we were able to see how every tool we analysed compared with each other, and which tools aligned best with the needs of students with neurodevelopmental disorders.

Below is the selection of tools we analysed, along with the task they were best aligned for:

Reading	Writing	Listening	Speaking
• Perplexity • Notebook LM • Knowt • Language tool • Wolfram alpha • Photomath	• Microsoft Copilot (w/ voice) • Quillbot	• Google Gemini (w/ live mode)	• Google Gemini (w/ live mode)

Below is the result from our analysis:

Final scores:

AI tool	Score
Perplexity	16.4 / 20
Notebook LM	15.6 / 20
Knowt	15.6 / 20
Quillbot	16.5 / 20
Language tool	12.9 / 20
Wolfram alpha	10.8 / 20
Photo math	11.8 / 20
Microsoft Copilot (w/ voice)	16.2 / 20
Google Gemini (w/ live mode)	16.5 / 20

Score breakdown:

Score range	Description
0 – 8.9	Not fit for purpose
9 – 11.9	Fit for purpose but may have limited use case.
12 – 13.9	Fit for purpose
14 – 15.9	Fit for purpose, has great features, and a good use case
16 or more	Fit for purpose, has excellent features, and a great use case.

From this we were able to create a further shortlist of tools:

Cardiff University Provide Gemini Notebook, Google Gemini, and Microsoft Copilot. This also helped us when deciding which tools to shortlist.

The final shortlisted tools:

Reading	Writing	Listening and speaking
• Perplexity • Notebook LM • Language tool	• Microsoft Copilot (w/ voice) • Quillbot	• Google Gemini (w/ live mode)

How did Copilot perform in our analysis?

Microsoft copilot (w/ voice)

Accessibility:

Indicator	What to look for	Rating 0 – 5
Clear and readable interface	Clean layout, readable fonts, minimal clutter	4
Accessible communication	Uses plain language and can simplify explanations	4
Multiple ways to interact	supports text, voice, images, or other input/output methods	4
Computability with accessibility features	Works with screen readers, keyboard navigation, text-to-speech, etc.	4
Sensory accessibility	Avoids overwhelming visuals or unnecessary distractions	4
Total		Points average: 4

Personalisation:

Indicator	What to look for	Points 0 – 5
Adaptive explanations	can simplify, expand, or rephrase content	5
Adjustable response style	User can request different formats, lengths, or levels of detail	5
Personalised feedback	Feedback reflects the learner's responses rather than generic advice	4
Supports individual learning pace	Learners can revisit, repeat, or build on previous explanations	4
Flexibility	Can generate examples, quizzes, summaries, or alternative explanations	4
Total		Points average: 4.4

Cognitive load management:

Indicator	What to look for	Points 0 – 5
Chunking information	Breaks information into manageable sections	4
Step by step guidance	Explains tasks sequentially	4
Concise explanations	Avoids unnecessary complexity or information overload	4
Organisation	Uses headings, bullet points, summaries, or logical structure	4
Attention support	Keeps responses focused and avoids irrelevant information	4
Total		Points average: 4

Pedagogical usefulness:

Indicator	What to look for	Points 0 – 5
Concept explanation	Explains reasoning rather than only giving answers	4
Constructive feedback	Identifies mistakes and explains how to improve	4
Encourages critical thinking	Prompts learners to think rather than simply copy	4
Supports independent learning	Helps learners solve problems themselves	4
Learning reinforcement	Provides examples, practice questions, summaries, or revision support	4
Total		Points average: 4

SCORE: 16.2 / 20

Learner profiles

Every student experience learning differently. To illustrate how neurodiversity can shape academic experiences, we've created a series of learner profiles based on common student experiences that learners that are neurodivergent may have. You can find these learner profiles below:

Profile 1: Hyperactive ADHD (Adam)

- **Demographics:** 18, 1st Year BA Modern Languages (English native, learning Spanish).
- **Core Profile:** Outgoing and highly creative, but struggles with executive dysfunction, time management, hyperfixation shifts, and finishing multi-step tasks.

Profile Dimension	Details & Strategies
Strengths	High energy, creativity, hyperfocus capacity, enthusiasm, strong social/conversational potential.
Academic Friction	Initiating unstructured study; managing long-term essay deadlines; remaining focused during long grammar lectures.
AI Matching Strategy	Use AI to externalise executive function and gamify micro-tasks.
Concrete AI Workflows	• Microsoft Copilot: "Break down my 2,000-word Spanish literature essay into 5 daily micro-tasks. Put deadlines on each and format as a checklist for Microsoft To-Do." • LanguageTool: Passively catches grammar/spelling errors while drafting without requiring dedicated editing sessions. • Perplexity AI: Focuses research queries to avoid falling down irrelevant internet "rabbit holes."
Assessment-Targeted Tasks	• Targeted Task (Coursework Essays): Prompt Copilot to build a structured 7-day writing roadmap with micro-deadlines. • Targeted Task (Grammar & Syntax Exams): Use LanguageTool for immediate feedback loops while practicing past papers. • Targeted Task (Literature & Culture Projects): Use Perplexity to gather verified, in-scope academic sources quickly without distraction.
Pedagogical Guardrail	Set strict time limits on AI interactions so hyperfocus isn't spent tweaking AI prompts instead of studying.

Profile 2: Inattentive ADHD (Amelia)

- **Demographics:** 18, 1st Year BA Modern Languages (English native, learning French).
- **Core Profile:** Deep thinker with strong pattern recognition but paralysed by high activation energy (task initiation), low executive resilience, and anxiety around foreign language speaking.

Profile Dimension	Details & Strategies
Strengths	Deep thinking, empathy, curiosity, conceptual pattern recognition.
Academic Friction	High task paralysis when staring at blank pages; anxiety surrounding real-time oral speaking in front of peers.
AI Matching Strategy	Use AI to lower initiation friction and provide low-stakes, judgement-free practice.
Concrete AI Workflows	• Google Gemini (Live Mode) / Copilot Voice: Low-stakes practice holding basic French conversations without peer-judgment or performance anxiety. • NotebookLM: Upload module reading PDFs to generate 3-bullet point summaries, reducing cognitive load before diving into full texts.
Assessment-Targeted Tasks	• Targeted Task (Oral Speaking Exams): Practice holding low-stakes, conversational roleplays with Gemini Live Mode to lower anxiety prior to real oral exams. • Targeted Task (Reading Comprehension Exams): Use NotebookLM to generate initial core summaries of dense set texts before reading the full material. • Targeted Task (Essay Planning): Prompt Copilot to generate 3 different starter outlines to overcome blank-page initiation paralysis.
Pedagogical Guardrail	Ensure she uses conversational AI as a stepping stone to build confidence for real human interaction, not as a permanent substitute.

Student Guide | Microsoft Copilot

Profile 3: Dyslexia (Samuel)

- **Demographics:** 19, 1st Year BA Modern Languages (Welsh national, limited Welsh, passionate about new languages).
- **Core Profile:** Resilient and creative, but experiences severe working memory load and processing friction when decoding written text, symbols, and spelling.

Profile Dimension	Details & Strategies
Strengths	Resilience, verbal communication, creative problem solving.
Academic Friction	Reading dense foreign text; accurate spelling/grammar in target languages; decoding written exam materials.
AI Matching Strategy	Transition from text-heavy interaction to multimodal (audio/visual) learning .
Concrete AI Workflows	• QuillBot & LanguageTool: Dual-proofreading layer to catch subtle grammatical inflections and orthographic errors. • Google Gemini (Multimodal Vision): Snap a photo of a printed Spanish text or worksheet → request audio read-back and simplified translation breakdowns. • NotebookLM: Convert dense syllabus PDFs into automatically generated audio overviews/podcasts and practice quizzes.
Assessment-Targeted Tasks	• Targeted Task (Written Composition & Reports): Use QuillBot and LanguageTool as a final proofreading step to catch spelling and grammar slips. • Targeted Task (Translation & Text Analysis): Snap photos of physical texts using Gemini to hear them read aloud while reviewing syntax. • Targeted Task (Revision & Knowledge Checks): Convert lecture slides and notes into automated practice quizzes using NotebookLM.
Pedagogical Guardrail	Require double-checking QuillBot output against class grammar rules, as AI suggestions can occasionally alter target-language nuances.

Profile 5: Slow Processing Speed (Declan)

- **Demographics:** 18, 1st Year BA Modern Languages (Bilingual Welsh/English).
- **Core Profile:** Accurate and deep thinker when given time but struggles to keep up with fast-paced live lectures and rapid spoken audio.

Profile Dimension	Details & Strategies
Strengths	High accuracy, deep conceptual understanding, methodical work habits.
Academic Friction	Taking real-time notes during lectures; rapid oral comprehension exercises; fast-paced seminar discussions.
AI Matching Strategy	Use AI for asynchronous pacing control and information distillation .
Concrete AI Workflows	• Copilot / Gemini Voice: Upload audio/video recordings of lectures to generate full transcripts, allowing Declan to review at his own pace. • NotebookLM: "Summarise this lecture transcript into core key takeaways and a 10-word vocabulary list to reduce reading volume."
Assessment-Targeted Tasks	• Targeted Task (Listening Comprehension Tests): Generate transcripts of practice audio using Copilot/Gemini to study sentence structure asynchronously. • Targeted Task (End-of-Term Exam Preparation): Use NotebookLM to condense voluminous term readings into high-priority core summary sheets. • Targeted Task (Seminar Preparation): Use NotebookLM to create pre-class key vocabulary lists to reduce real-time cognitive processing load.
Pedagogical Guardrail	Ensure audio transcripts are reviewed alongside lecture slides to verify technical term accuracy.

Profile 4: Autistic Learner (Austin)

- **Demographics:** 18, 1st Year BSc Computer Science (Welsh national, English speaking).
- **Core Profile:** Highly analytical with deep attention to detail, but vulnerable to sensory overload, unpredictable environment shifts, and figurative/ambiguous language.

Profile Dimension	Details & Strategies
Strengths	Logical thinking, detail accuracy, systematic problem solving, high reliability.
Academic Friction	Interpreting non-literal assignment prompts; managing sensory overload during crowded lectures; navigating group work.
AI Matching Strategy	Use AI as a clarifier to strip away ambiguity and create explicit structure .
Concrete AI Workflows	• Copilot / NotebookLM: Direct prompt: "Rewrite these assignment instructions into literal, step-by-step instructions. Remove metaphorical language and list explicit deliverables." • NotebookLM: Converts lecture notes into structured visual diagrams, explicit glossaries, and factual Q&As to study in a quiet, low-sensory setting.
Assessment-Targeted Tasks	• Targeted Task (Interpreting Assignment Briefs): Paste module rubrics into Copilot to generate explicit, step-by-step deliverable checklists. • Targeted Task (Theoretical/Conceptual Exams): Use NotebookLM to compile literal, factual glossaries and visual diagrams from course files. • Targeted Task (Group Project Planning): Use Copilot to clearly divide tasks and write unambiguous communication templates for team members.
Pedagogical Guardrail	Explicitly define parameters for AI use so Austin understands exact academic integrity boundary lines.

Profile 6: Auditory Processing Disorder - APD (Sebastian)

- **Demographics:** 18, 1st Year BA Modern Languages (English native, limited Spanish).
- **Core Profile:** Visual learner who struggles to distinguish and process spoken auditory input, leading to fatigue in listening exercises.

Profile Dimension	Details & Strategies
Strengths	Visual processing capacity, spatial learning, resilience, hands-on learning.
Academic Friction	Foreign language listening exams; auditory lectures; background noise in oral seminars.
AI Matching Strategy	Convert auditory input into visual text and visual diagrams .
Concrete AI Workflows	• Google Gemini / Copilot Live: Live transcription of spoken class audio into formatted, real-time written text. • NotebookLM: Input audio recordings to produce written study summaries, mind maps, and flashcard sets, completely bypassing auditory fatigue.
Assessment-Targeted Tasks	• Targeted Task (Audio/Listening Assessments): Practice with Gemini by pairing spoken audio outputs directly with real-time screen transcription. • Targeted Task (Lecture Content Mastery): Process lecture audio through NotebookLM to create visual mind maps and text notes. • Targeted Task (Vocabulary Building): Convert audio flashcards into visual/written vocabulary matrices.
Pedagogical Guardrail	Target language phonology still needs practice; use synchronised text-and-audio playback tools rather than cutting out listening entirely.

Disclaimers

- Always use your Cardiff University email address to access any AI tools recommended by the University. Where available, use the University-provided or University-approved versions of these tools. This helps ensure that your data is protected under Cardiff University's security, privacy and data protection arrangements.
- Avoid sharing personal, confidential, or sensitive information with AI tools whenever possible. This includes information about yourself, other students, staff members or any data that could identify an individual.
- The advice provided in this guide, and in any related University guidance, is intended to support your learning and should be considered guidance rather than a set of mandatory rules. You should always use your own judgement and follow any instructions provided by your module leaders or the University.
- AI-generated content is not always accurate. AI tools can sometimes produce incorrect, misleading, incomplete, or fabricated information (often referred to as "hallucinations"). You should carefully review, verify and critically evaluate all AI-generated outputs before using them in your studies.
- Use AI as a learning aid, not as a substitute for your own work. AI can help you understand concepts, organise ideas, practise language skills and receive feedback, but it should not be used to plagiarise or misrepresent work as your own. Always follow Cardiff University's policies on academic integrity and appropriate use of AI.

Microsoft Copilot

What disorders can this tool help with?

Autism

This guide draws on research comparing the tasks that can be completed using Microsoft Copilot, and its characteristics to issues students with autism may experience. Below will describe how the selected tasks have been set out further along with this guide, involving Microsoft copilot, can help autistic learners.

This guide is informed by an analysis of Microsoft Copilot's features and capabilities in relation to common experiences and support needs among autistic students. The following sections describe how the Microsoft Copilot tasks included throughout the guide may help autistic learners engage more effectively with their studies.

Planning tasks

Planning tasks and upcoming projects can be done simpler with Copilot. The simplicity of setting out a plan with copilot, can help eliminate sensory overload. Sometimes, prioritising tasks can be hard for autistic learners, this is why this feature is useful. You can give a wide range of information to copilot requiring your task (**That is not sensitive and/ or personal**) and it can quickly craft an effective, time managed plan.

Re-writing and/ or summarising texts

Rewriting and summarising texts can be completed quickly and easily with Microsoft Copilot. Research suggests that some autistic learners may find it challenging to interpret information when it is unclear, ambiguous, overly complex or open to multiple interpretations. Copilot can support understanding by rephrasing text in simpler language, summarising key points or presenting information in a more structured and accessible format. Clear, direct and unambiguous communication can help autistic learners process information more effectively, reduce misunderstandings and focus on the most important content.

ADHD

This guide is informed by a comparison of Microsoft Copilot's capabilities and the challenges that learners with ADHD may experience in academic settings. The sections below explain how the Microsoft Copilot tasks included throughout this guide can support learners with ADHD in managing their studies more effectively.

Based on the findings of this research, a comparison was undertaken between the functionality of Microsoft Copilot and challenges frequently experienced by students with ADHD. The following sections describe how the tasks and activities presented in this guide may help support learners with ADHD throughout their academic journey.

Planning tasks

Planning tasks and upcoming projects can be done simpler with Copilot. The simplicity of setting out a plan with copilot can reduce required mental resilience. Sometimes, prioritising tasks can be hard for learners with ADHD. We have recognised that quickly and efficiently being able to plan and prioritise takes may be beneficial to those with ADHD. You can give a wide range of information to copilot requiring your task (**That is not sensitive and/ or personal**) and it can quickly craft an effective, time managed plan.

Processing disorders

This guide is informed by a comparison of Microsoft Copilot capabilities and the challenges that learners with processing disorders may experience in academic settings. The sections below explain how the Microsoft Copilot tasks included throughout this guide can support learners with processing disorders in managing their studies more effectively.

This guide was developed by aligning the capabilities of Microsoft Copilot with challenges frequently encountered by students with processing disorders. The sections that follow present a range of tasks and activities that can be undertaken using Microsoft Copilot, highlighting their potential to support learning, organisation, and information processing.

Typing

Typing may be harder or take longer for those with certain processing disorders. Copilot allows for inputs to be created, via voice. A learner with processing disorders can follow.

Dyspraxia

This guide draws on research comparing the tasks that can be completed using Microsoft Copilot, and its characteristics to issues students with dyspraxia may experience. Below will describe how the selected tasks have been set out further along with this guide, involving Microsoft copilot, can help learners with dyspraxia.

This guide is informed by an analysis of Microsoft Copilot's features and capabilities in relation to common experiences and support needs among learners with dyspraxia. The following sections describe how the Microsoft Copilot tasks included throughout the guide may help learners with dyspraxia learners engage more effectively with their studies.

Prompts with voice

The findings informing this guide suggest that, due to the characteristics of dyspraxia, physical note-taking may be more difficult for some learners, potentially affecting the speed and efficiency with which information is recorded. Microsoft Copilot has a feature that allows for voice-to-text inputs, allowing for notetaking and use of copilot to be possible with voice input

Planning tasks

Students with dyspraxia often encounter challenges in organising, structuring, and managing information effectively. Planning tasks and projects can be done easier with copilot, as a learner can use copilot as an assistant for planning and organising tasks and timelines.

Microsoft Copilot can support learners who find typing difficult or time-consuming. Some learners with processing disorders may experience challenges in translating their thoughts into written text quickly or accurately. Copilot's voice input functionality allows users to dictate prompts and instructions verbally rather than relying solely on typing. This can reduce the effort associated with text production, support the communication of ideas more efficiently, and enable learners to focus on the content of their work rather than the mechanics of writing. By offering alternative ways to interact with technology, Copilot can help make learning tasks more accessible and manageable.

What Modern Languages assessments/ tasks this tool can help with

Grammar tests

Provide step-by-step grammar explanations, practice exercises and personalised feedback on recurring errors.

Example Prompt

"Act as a French grammar tutor [Role]. Explain the difference between the *passé composé* and *imparfait* with contextual examples and create a 6-question practice quiz [Task]. I am a first-year undergraduate student preparing for a B1 language grammar exam [Context]."

Reading comprehension tests

Simplify texts, explain vocabulary, break readings into smaller sections and generate summaries.

Example Prompt

"Act as a text analyst and language coach [Role]. Break this article into clear sections, summarise each paragraph, and explain the difficult vocabulary [Task]. I am a first-year undergraduate student practicing reading comprehension for my Spanish language module [Context]."

Written Language Exercises

Support planning, organisation, proofreading and identification of language errors.

Example Prompt

"Act as a supportive language proofreader [Role]. Review my Italian writing exercise, highlight grammatical or structural errors, and explain how to fix them [Task]. I am completing a controlled writing assessment for my university language course [Context]."

Translation into English

Explain sentence structures and translation choices.

Example prompt

"Act as a professional translation mentor [Role]. Compare two possible English translations of this target language sentence and explain which is more appropriate in context [Task]. I am a language student working on a translation assessment into English [Context]."

Translation into the Target Language

Support vocabulary selection and explain grammar decisions.

Example prompt

"Act as a native Japanese language tutor [Role]. Paraphrase my draft translation to show 3 alternative ways of communicating the exact same idea in Japanese [Task]. I am practicing translation into the target language for my university coursework [Context]."

Oral Examinations

Provide speaking practice, mock conversations and pronunciation support.

Example Prompt

"Act as a Spanish oral examiner [Role]. Ask me one follow-up question at a time about environmental issues and provide brief feedback on my answers [Task]. I am preparing for a structured university oral examination [Context]."

Interviews/vivas

Simulate interview scenarios and generate practice questions.

Example prompt

"Act as an academic panel interviewer [Role]. Generate a mock interview scenario about my year abroad experience along with 3 likely follow-up questions [Task]. I am preparing for an interactive viva assessment for my language degree [Context]."

Mediation task

Activities requiring students to convey information, ideas, or concepts between languages and cultural contexts. Cardiff identifies mediation as a core language skill.

Example prompt

"Act as an intercultural communication expert [Role]. Summarise this French article for a UK audience and identify key points that require cultural adaptation [Task]. I am working on a year 1 mediation assignment [Context]."

Essays

Support brainstorming, planning, organisation and proofreading.

Example Prompt

"Act as a research and essay planning assistant [Role]. Help me outline a logical essay plan on the representation of migration in contemporary Spanish cinema without writing the text [Task]. I am writing a critical content essay for my modern languages module [Context]."

Exams

Generate revision plans, summaries and practice questions.

Example prompt

"Act as an academic revision coach [Role]. Generate a structured 2-week revision plan and 3 practice questions based on past exam topics [Task]. I am preparing for an end-of-year Spanish written examination [Context]."

Presentations

Individual or group presentations delivered in the target language and/or English.

Example Prompt

"Act as a presentation designer [Role]. Create an outline for a slide deck on French identity and multiculturalism, including bulleted discussion points per slide [Task]. I am an undergraduate preparing an individual oral presentation [Context]."

Poster presentations

Suggest layouts, simplify information and improve visual organisation.

Example prompt

"Act as a visual communications specialist [Role]. Suggest a clear poster layout and condense this 1,000-word research summary into concise bullet points [Task]. I am creating a poster presentation for my cultural studies assessment [Context]."

Dissertation

Assist with planning, literature organisation, note-taking and project management.

Example prompt

"Act as an academic project supervisor [Role]. Create a step-by-step project timeline and help identify emerging themes from these research source notes: [paste notes] [Task]. I am writing my final-year independent dissertation project [Context]."

Vlogs

Assist with storyboarding, scripting and planning.

Example prompt

"Act as a creative media planner [Role]. Create a step-by-step storyboard script outlining a vlog that reflects on intercultural experiences [Task]. I am producing a target-language vlog for a digital assignment [Context]."

Desktop usage

Setting up/ signing in

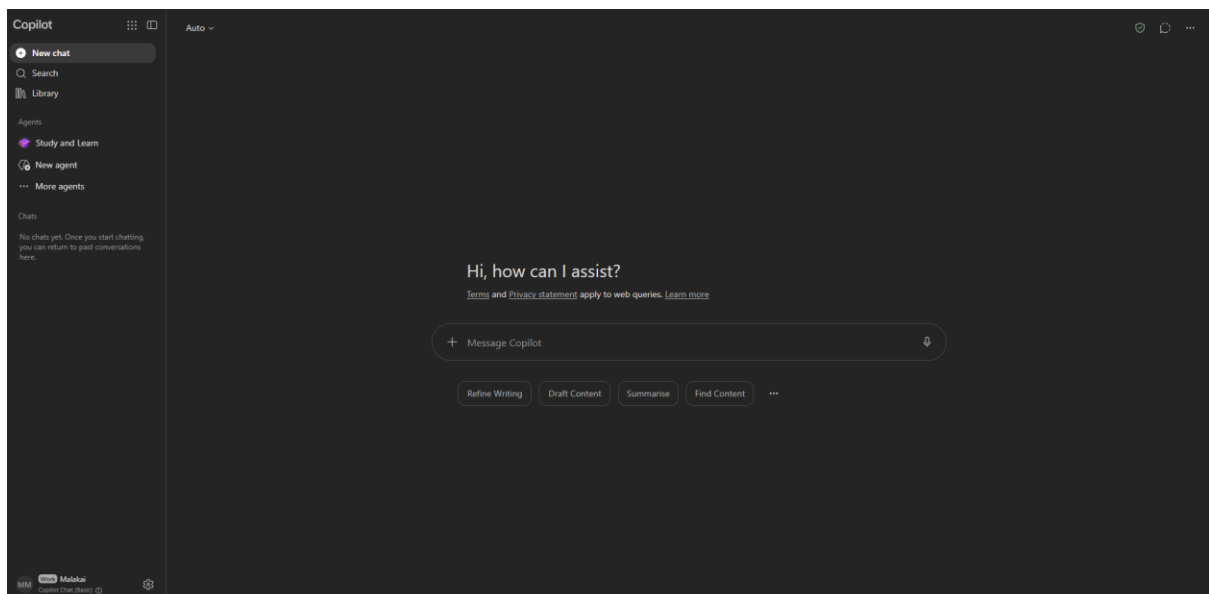
How to do this

You can access Microsoft 365 Copilot but simply searching “Microsoft 365 Copilot” into Google Chrome and select the first appropriate result. From that point you can sign in with your Cardiff University email address.

Disclaimer: We suggest that only sign in/ sign up to the AI tools we suggest with your Cardiff University email address where possible.

After set up/ signing in

You should be greeted with the following interface:



From this point, you have access to Microsoft 365 Copilot, provided by Cardiff University. The bar that contains “Message Copilot” is where you can interact with Copilot. And the menu on the left contains (or will contain) your chat history, with the option to create a new chat.

The “Message Copilot” bar is where you type out your information. *It is worth noting that Copilot allows you to use voice inputs, with the microphone option to the right most part of the “Message Copilot” bar.*

Planning tasks

Microsoft copilot can help you plan out tasks. If you give Microsoft Copilot your task, its characteristics and your time frame, along with any other relevant information, it can help you plan and break down tasks for you.

Disclaimer: We suggest that only give information/ data to an AI that isn't personal and or sensitive.

How to do this

An example of a prompt that you could give Copilot to plan a task, is as follows:

“I have an essay due in a week and 3 days. This essay is on the roman empire, and it will be roughly three thousand words. Can you give me a breakdown/ daily plan to help be time manage this task”

This is the result of me pasting this example prompt into Copilots “Message Copilot” Bar:

The screenshot shows the Microsoft Copilot interface with a prompt: "I have an essay due in a week...". The response is a structured plan for writing an essay, broken down into daily tasks with specific goals and time commitments.

Day 6: Write Third Section (700-800 words)

- Develop another major argument/theme.
- Link ideas clearly between sections.

Goal: Reach ~2,000 words total.

Day 7: Finish Main Body + Conclusion (700-900 words)

- Complete final section.
- Write conclusion.

Goal: Complete first draft (~3,000 words).

Day 8: Rest and Review

Take several hours away from the essay before returning.

Then:

- Read through the entire draft.
- Check:
 - Flow
 - Argument strength
 - Missing evidence
 - Repetition

Goal: Identify weaknesses.

Day 9: Editing and Referencing (1-2 hours)

- Improve clarity and academic style.
- Verify citations and bibliography.
- Check formatting requirements.

Goal: Produce a polished second draft.

Day 10: Final Proofread and Submission

- Read aloud if possible.
- Check:
 - Grammar
 - Spelling
 - Word count
 - Referencing style
- Submit.

Goal: Finish calmly, not at the last minute.

Daily Time Commitment

Day	Task	Time
1	Understand question	30-60 mins
2	Research	1.5-2 hrs
3	Research + plan	1.5-2 hrs
4	Intro + Section 1	1-2 hrs
5	Section 2	1-2 hrs
6	Section 3	1-2 hrs
7	Finish draft	1-2 hrs
8	Review	1 hr
9	Edit + references	1-2 hrs
10	Final proofread	30-60 mins

Copilot was able to give me a full breakdown/ plan, personalised to the information I gave it. A great feature within Copilot, is that you can ask it to redo things, for example. If you realised you were not available one of those days, you could tell it to redo the plan it has created and take that into consideration.

Cardiff University also provide Microsoft To-Do, which is an easy-to-use planner, then can be used alongside Microsoft Outlook Calander, to help you manage your tasks. We suggest that you combine a task breakdown like this, with a calendar tool, such as Microsoft To-Do.

Summarising Texts

Microsoft copilot can help you summarise and customise texts. If you give Microsoft copilot your text, it can help you summarise and customise it based on your requirements.

Disclaimer: Users are strongly advised not to input personal, sensitive, confidential, or identifiable information into AI tools. Only information that can be shared safely and ethically should be used, in accordance with institutional policies and relevant data protection requirements.

How to do this

Here is a big wall of text (Blue font) explaining how Large Language Models work (You do not have to read it)

“Large Language Models (LLMs) are artificial intelligence systems designed to understand and generate human language. They are trained on massive amounts of text collected from books, websites, articles, and other written sources. During training, the model learns patterns in language by analysing how words and sentences are related to each other. Rather than memorizing facts, it learns statistical relationships between words, allowing it to predict what text is most likely to come next in a sequence.

At the core of most modern LLMs is a neural network architecture called a **Transformer**. Transformers use a mechanism known as **attention**, which helps the model determine which words in a sentence are most important when generating a response. For example, when processing a question, the model can focus on relevant parts of the input rather than treating every word equally. This enables it to handle complex language tasks such as answering questions, summarizing text, translating between languages, and writing content.

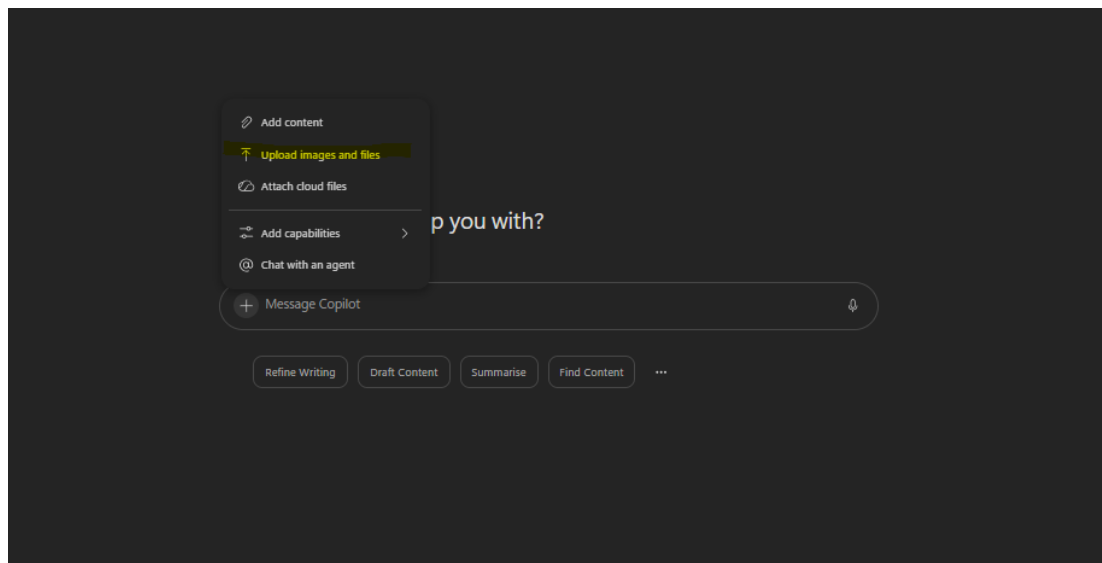
Training an LLM typically involves two stages. First, the model undergoes **pre-training**, where it learns general language patterns by predicting missing or next words in enormous text datasets. Second, it may go through **fine-tuning**, where it is trained on more specific data and adjusted using human feedback to improve the quality, safety, and usefulness of its responses.

When a user enters a prompt, the LLM converts the text into numerical representations called **tokens** and processes them through its neural network. It then calculates the probabilities of possible next tokens and generates a response one token at a time. Although LLMs can appear to reason and understand concepts, they do not think or possess true understanding in the same way humans do. Instead, they generate outputs based on patterns learned from their training data.

The impressive capabilities of LLMs have made them useful in many areas, including education, software development, research, customer support, and content creation. However, they are not perfect and can sometimes produce incorrect or misleading information, known as **hallucinations**. As a result, important outputs should always be verified using reliable sources. Despite these limitations, LLMs represent a major advancement in artificial intelligence and continue to improve as models become larger, more efficient, and better aligned with human needs”

This text will be used to display how copilot can manipulate this text for me. This will be uploaded as a one-page PDF to copilot. You can do this by clicking the “+” symbol that is to the left most part of the “Message Copilot” bar, and then clicking “Upload images and files” at which point will bring up your file explorer. Or you can simply drag and drop files from your file explorer.

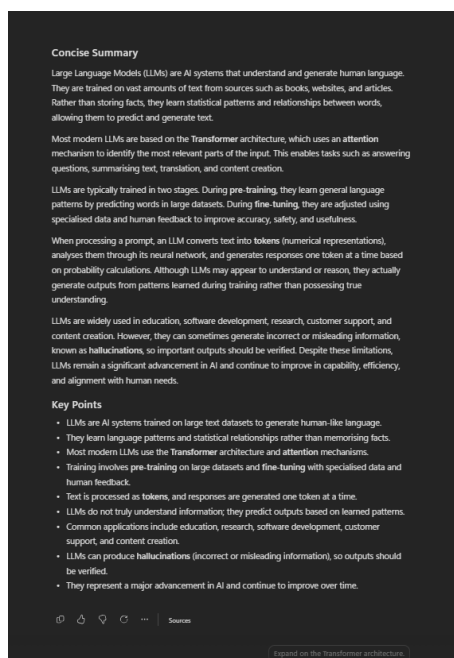
For reference:



An example of a prompt that you could give Copilot to complete this task, is as follows:

“Can you summarise this text, keep all the meaningful information, just make it clear and concise. Can you also make a small bullet point list for a summary of the main points”

This is the result I had from pasting this example prompt into Copilot:



Copilot was able to give a well-done summary that follows the characteristics of the request. This is an example of just one of the ways you can customise text, to better align with what you need, with Copilot.

Rewriting Texts

Microsoft copilot can help you rewrite tasks. If you give Microsoft copilot your text, it can help you summarise and customise your text.

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How to do this

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At the core of most modern LLMs is a neural network architecture called a **Transformer**. Transformers use a mechanism known as **attention**, which helps the model determine which words in a sentence are most important when generating a response. For example, when processing a question, the model can focus on relevant parts of the input rather than treating every word equally. This enables it to handle complex language tasks such as answering questions, summarizing text, translating between languages, and writing content.

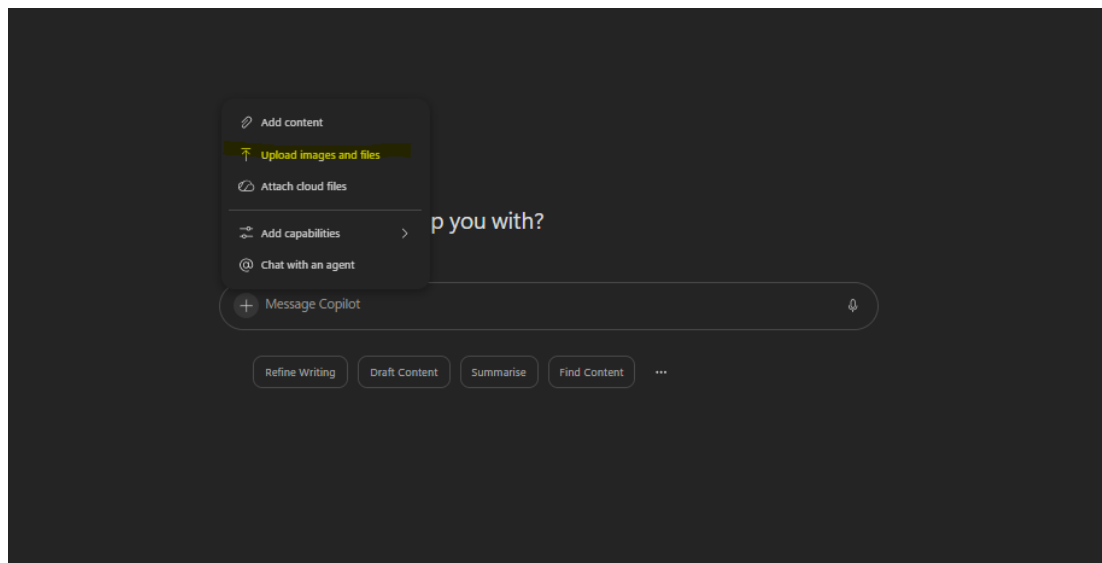
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When a user enters a prompt, the LLM converts the text into numerical representations called **tokens** and processes them through its neural network. It then calculates the probabilities of possible next tokens and generates a response one token at a time. Although LLMs can appear to reason and understand concepts, they do not think or possess true understanding in the same way humans do. Instead, they generate outputs based on patterns learned from their training data.

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I am going to use this text to display how copilot can rewrite this text for me. I will be uploading this wall of text as a one-page PDF to copilot. You can do this by clicking the “+” symbol that is to the left most part of the “Message Copilot” bar, and then clicking “Upload images and files” at which point will bring up your file explorer. Or you can simply drag and drop files from your file explorer.

For reference:

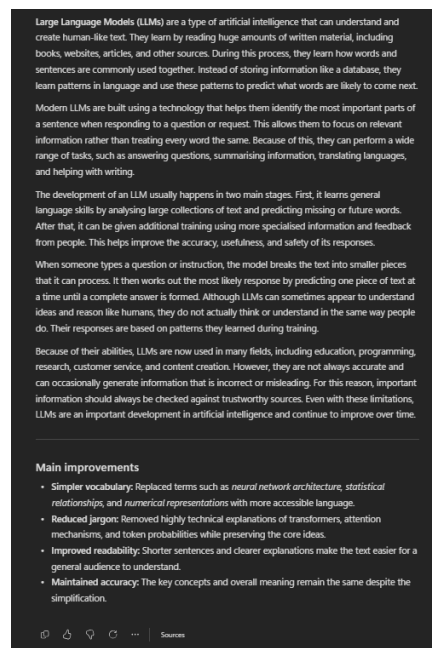


To showcase how Copilot can help you rewrite texts, I will be using it to rewrite this text to make this text lean towards a less technical reader and asking it to paraphrase using simpler language instead.

An example of a prompt that you could give Copilot to complete this task, is as follows:

“Can you re-write this text, in a way that makes it sound less technical. Please can you paraphrase, using simpler terminology, and less technical language”

Here is the result of me pasting the example prompt into Copilot “Message Copilot”:



Copilot was able to professionally re-write the text, following what I asked the tool closely, and even going as far as to say what it improved for me.

Mobile usage

Setting up/ signing in

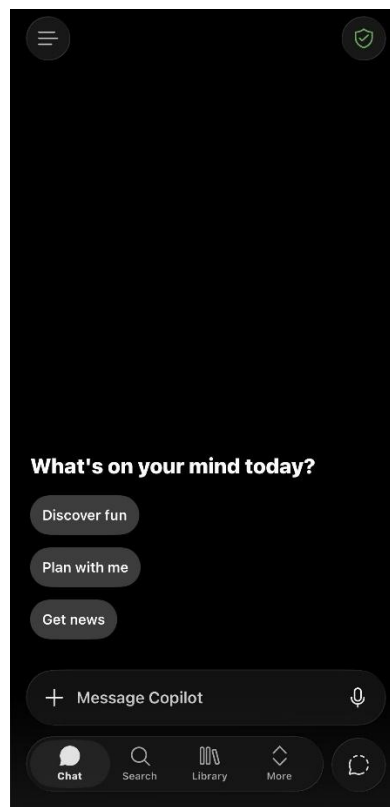
How to do this

You can access Microsoft 365 Copilot but simply going to your mobile's app store and search "Microsoft 365 Copilot" and install "Microsoft Copilot". From that point you can sign in with your Cardiff University email address.

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After set up/ signing in

You should be greeted with the following interface:



From this point, you have access to Microsoft 365 Copilot, provided by Cardiff University. The bar that contains "Message Copilot" is where you can interact with Copilot. The button in the top left part of the interface will show a side menu that contains (or will contain) your chat history, with the option to create a new chat.

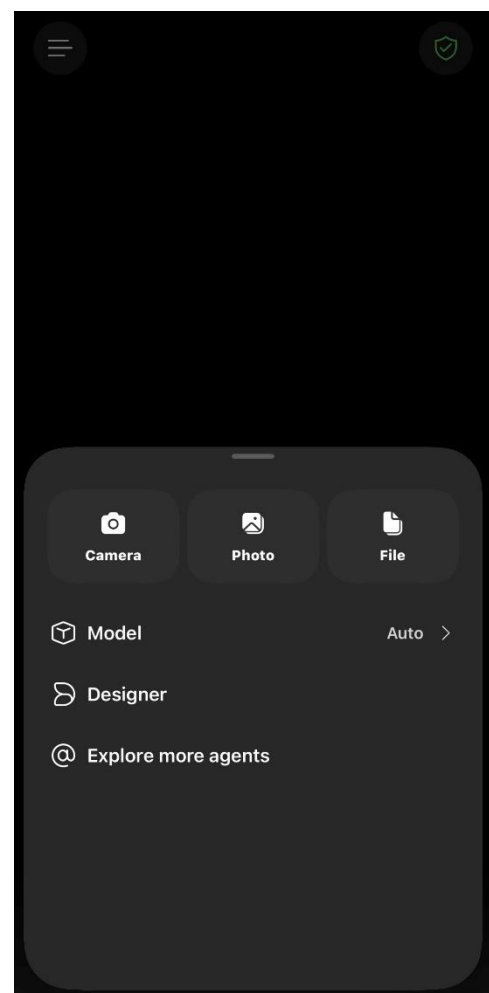
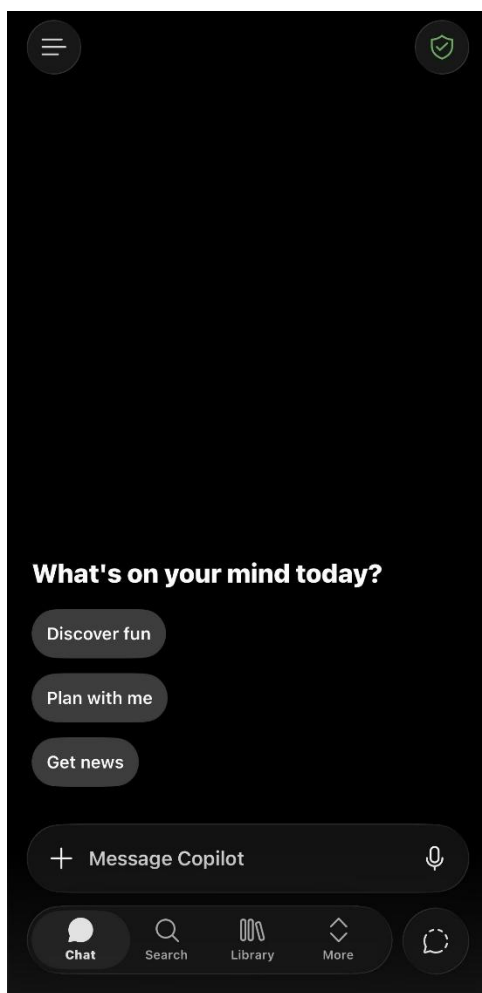
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Photo with prompts

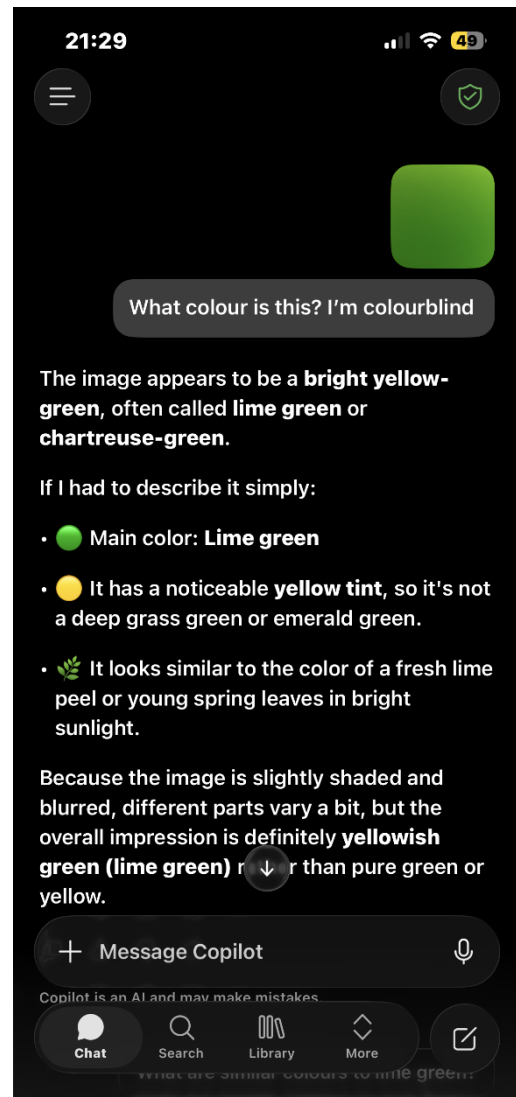
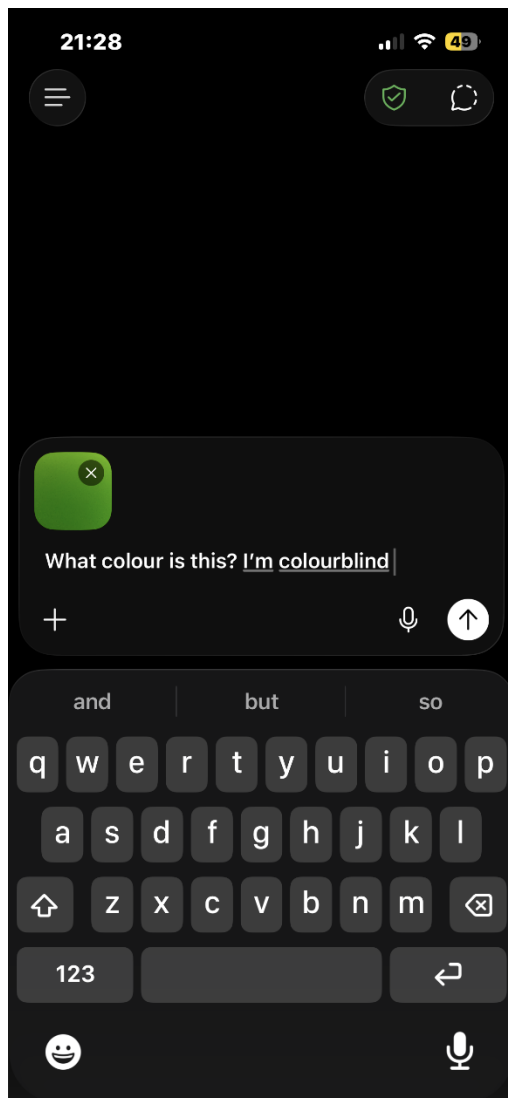
On the mobile version of Copilot, you can take photos within the app and then upload them alongside prompts. For instance, if you have a worksheet, and you need help with it, you can upload a picture taken right in the app, alongside prompting “Can you help me with this, I’m confused with...”. You can also ask Copilot to summarise the images you’re uploading, if there’s a lot of information. You can view this as another way of prompting Copilot. Like uploading a file on the desktop version.

For reference:

Click the “+” button in the “Message Copilot” Bar, and then click the “Camera” button



And then take your photo, and prompt it with the task you want copilot to complete, or a question you have about your image



Copilot was able to answer the question about my image. This is the main benefit of having the mobile version of Copilot. This is just one example of the ways that you can prompt with photos. As I previously mentioned, this can be used for things such as worksheets and being stuck on a question.

Further recourses (Provided by Cardiff University)

Further guidance for using Copilot

<https://intranet.cardiff.ac.uk/students/applications/help/using-copilot>

References

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[https://rbwm.afcinfo.org.uk/pages/local-offer/information-and-](https://rbwm.afcinfo.org.uk/pages/local-offer/information-and-advice/education/about-sen-support-in-schools/ordinarily-available-provision/barriers-)

[advice/education/about-sen-support-in-schools/ordinarily-available-provision/barriers-](https://rbwm.afcinfo.org.uk/pages/local-offer/information-and-advice/education/about-sen-support-in-schools/ordinarily-available-provision/barriers-)

to-learning/barrier-to-learning-poor-attention-and-concentration-and-or-hyperactivity-adhd (Accessed: 10 September 2026).

Cardiff University Support services

<https://www.cardiff.ac.uk/study/student-life/student-support/disability-and-dyslexia-service>